

Blizzard

Game creator sues
StarCraftII hack creators

Windows games marketplace

Microsoft is launching a marketplace for Windows and Xbox users called "Games for Windows" marketplace on November 15th



By Faiyaz Shaikh

Dead Rising 2, just like its predecessor, has a lot of potential to be a mindless zombie killing carnival; however, some aspects of the game suck the fun right out.

The zombie outbreak from the first game — as zombie outbreaks typically do — have spread to other parts of the Dead Rising game world. *Dead Rising 2* follows one such massive outbreak in a place called Fortune City which is not much different from the location of the first game. A few new game elements have been introduced in the sequel, but largely it is just like the first game.

Take the good with the bad

The most interesting and significant of these changes is the introduction of a weapon crafting system called Combo Weapons. Sundry objects and food items scattered throughout the game world can be combined to create new and sometimes powerful weapons. This was the single aspect of the game which kept us going right till the end. While some of these combined weapons are very efficient for racking up zombie kills, others are just good for some laughs at the cost of your undead brethren. However, just like everything else in the game, the designers had to make this just a little too hard. Weapons can only be combined by using work benches in maintenance rooms which are rare and farflung.

Rapid Questing with high latency

Just like its ancestor, this game is entirely restricted by time. So, completing the main storyline requires rushing through most of the game. There is a lot of running around back and forth across the map and this translates into a lot of lengthy loading screens. Consequently, you end up spending more time staring at the screen than actually playing the game. Worse still, even the game's cut-scenes have loading screens. The saving system involves saving only at restrooms, which are even rarer than the maintenance rooms. So, failing a quest or dying means that you often have to endure another long session with multiple loading screens. While the game is a lot of fun, this bit really tests the resolve.

Age of Zombies

Some may argue that Zombies have been done to death in both movies, and in video games; while others would dismiss this argument as blasphemy.

Genre: Action

Studio: Blue Castle

Publisher: Capcom

***Platforms:** PS3, Xbox 360 (reviewed on Xbox 360)

Price: PS3, Xbox: ₹2, 999/-

Pros:

Weapons crafting is the best and only significant addition introduced in the sequel.

Unlimited zombies for eternal maiming pleasure. Multiple endings

Cons:

Way too many loading screens

Time restricted quests

prevents exploration

Frustrating save system

Badly crafted cut-scenes

Verdict:

Dead Rising 2, just like its predecessor, has a lot of potential to be a mindless zombie killing carnival; however, some aspects of the game suck the fun right out

There is something about this theme that enables a unique blend of humor and unabashed violence, minus the guilt. In this respect at least, *Dead Rising 2* is pretty true to its genre. Except the restrictions which are in complete contrast to the game's setting which is meant for exploration and experimentation. ■

